

Workforce Skills for Business 2030: Navigating the Future of Work in an AI-Augmented Economy

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ABSTRACT

The accelerating convergence of Artificial Intelligence, automation, and digital transformation is fundamentally reshaping the skills landscape for the global business workforce. This paper investigates the critical workforce skills that will define organisational competitiveness by 2030, with a focus on Indian businesses in a digitally transforming economy. A sequential exploratory mixed-methods design is employed: first, a three-round Delphi methodology with a panel of 42 industry experts across seven sectors, followed by a quantitative survey of 278 HR professionals and business leaders. The findings yield a validated Future Skills Taxonomy for Business 2030 comprising four clusters - Digital & Technological Literacy, Cognitive & Analytical Agility, Human-Centred Leadership, and Adaptive Collaboration. Three hypotheses are tested through multiple regression analysis: learning culture ($\beta = 0.44$), leadership commitment ($\beta = 0.38$), and L&D budget allocation ($\beta = 0.29$) are the strongest predictors of reskilling programme effectiveness ($R^2 = 0.613$). A critical finding is that 79.3% of organisations acknowledge the urgency of future-skills development, yet

Keywords: Future Skills 2030; AI & Automation; Workforce Capabilities; Reskilling Programs; Learning & Development

1. Macro-Environmental Drivers of Workforce Disruption

Generative AI, enterprise robotics, and algorithmic systems are automating routine cognitive tasks at unprecedented speed. Consequently, human workers must cultivate synthesis capabilities, ethical judgment, and complex socio-emotional problem solving.

2. The Four Pillars of the 2030 Future Skills Taxonomy

Empirical survey results identify four essential competencies: (1) Technical fluency and prompt engineering; (2) Critical analysis and contextual skepticism; (3) Empathic leadership; and (4) Continuous self-directed learning adaptability.

3. Institutional Challenges in Corporate Reskilling Programs

Despite high conceptual awareness among corporate leaders, substantial bottlenecks persist around measurement methodologies for reskilling ROI and outdated pedagogical models in traditional corporate training academies.

4. Conclusion & Framework Implementation Roadmap

Organizations must transition from static job-title paradigms to fluid skill-cluster architectures. Investing in experiential learning labs and collaborative AI workflows will determine corporate survivability in the 2030 economy.

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